

Vocabulário e phrasal verbs

20 questões · 1.3 por prova · Inglês · 10 por prova · 6,25% da nota

As questões aparecem **como imagem do caderno original da ESPM** — com mapas, charges, gráficos, frações e expoentes exatamente como na prova. Cada uma traz a prova e o número. Gabarito oficial no fim.

How James Brown Made Black Pride a Hit

It's been 50 years since he wrote "Say It Loud, I'm Black and I'm Proud," a song that is still necessary.

By Randall Kennedy

In the gym at Paul Junior High School in Washington, D.C., in the spring of 1968, not that long before the assassination of the Rev. Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., I asked a buddy whether he was interested in a certain girl. He told me that he was not because she was too dark.



*He and I were African-American. (Then we would have called ourselves Negro.) So was she. All of us supported the Civil Rights Movement and idolized Dr. King, yet I did not hold my friend's color-struck judgment against him. And he did not state his opinion with embarrassment. **We had both internalized our society's derogation of blackness.***

Indeed, we luxuriated in the denigration, spending hours trading silly, recycled but revealing insults: "Yo mama so black, she blend in with the chalkboard." "Yeah, well, yo mama so black, she sweats chocolate."

It was precisely because of widespread colorism that James Brown's anthem "Say It Loud, I'm Black and I'm Proud" posed a challenge, felt so exhilarating, and resonated so powerfully. It still does. Much has changed over the past half century. But, alas, the need to defend blackness against derision continues.

Various musicians in the 1960s tapped into yearnings for black assertiveness, autonomy and solidarity. Curtis Mayfield

and the Impressions sang "We're a Winner." Sly and the Family Stone offered "Stand." Sam Cooke (and Aretha Franklin and Otis Redding) performed "A Change is Gonna Come." But no entertainer equaled Brown's vocalization of African-Americans' newly triumphal sense of self-acceptance.

That Brown created the song most popularly associated with the Black is Beautiful movement is ironic. He generally stayed away from protest, endorsed the presidential re-election of Richard Nixon, lavishly praised Ronald Reagan, and consistently lauded Strom Thurmond.

His infrequent sallies into politics usually sounded in patriotic, lift-yourself-up-ism. In the song "America is My Home," he proclaimed without embarrassment that the United States "is still the best country / And that's without a doubt." Alluding to his own trajectory, he challenged dissenters to name any other country in which a person could start out as a poor shoeshine boy but end up as a wealthy celebrity shaking hands with the president.

At the very time that in "Say It Loud," Brown seemed to be affirming Negritude, he also sported a "conk" — a distinctive hairdo that involved chemically removing kinkiness on the way to creating a bouffant of straightened hair. Many African-American political activists, especially those with a black nationalist orientation, decried the conk as an illustration of racial self-hatred. For a brief period, Brown abandoned the conk and adopted an Afro, but that was only temporary. The conk was part of the characteristic look of "The Godfather of Soul."

Even though by 1968 uprisings against white supremacism had been erupting for a decade with great intensity and success — the Montgomery Bus Boycott, the Children's Crusade in Birmingham, the protest against disenfranchisement in Selma — prejudice against blackness remained prevalent, including among African-Americans.

Champions of African-American uplift in the 1960s sought to liberate blackness from the layers of contempt, fear, and hatred with which it had been smeared for centuries. Brown's anthem poignantly reflected the

psychic problem it sought to address. People secure in their status don't feel compelled to trumpet their pride. At the same time "Say it Loud!" was a rousing instance of a reclamation that took many forms. Instead of celebrating light skin, thin lips, and "good" (i.e., straight) hair, increasing numbers of African-Americans began valorizing dark skin, thick lips and "bad" (i.e., kinky) hair.

The reclamation of blackness in the sixties made tremendous headway quickly. By 1970 my friend would not have dared to repeat out loud what he had told me unapologetically two years before. Here, as elsewhere, however, changes wrought by the black liberation movement, though impressive, were only partial. Nearly four decades after the release of "Say It Loud," Professors Jennifer Hochschild and Vesla Weaver, having synthesized the pertinent academic literature, declared authoritatively that compared to their lighter-skinned counterparts, dark-skinned blacks continue to be burdened by lower levels of education, income, and job status. They receive longer prison sentences and are less likely to own homes or to marry. Filmmakers, advertisers, modeling agencies, dating websites and other key gatekeepers demonstrate repeatedly the ongoing pertinence of the old saw: If you're black get back. If you're brown, stick around. If you're white you're alright.

Intraracial colorism in Black America is often seen as a topic that should, if possible, be avoided, especially in "mixed company." That sense of embarrassment three decades ago prompted officials at Morehouse College to demand that Spike Lee cease filming on campus once they learned that his movie was exposing, among other things, black collegiate colorism. The impulse toward avoidance remains strong.

With racial prejudice against all African-Americans still a potent force, many would just as soon ditch the discussion of "black on black" complexional bias. Colorism, however, remains a baleful reality.

Half a century after James Brown's proclamation, it remains imperative to assert what should have been assumed and uncontroversial all along: that black is beautiful and as worthy of pride and care and consideration as any other hue.

(Adapted from: www.nytimes.com, 20/07/2018)

Questão 50

The use of the prepositions "up" and "out" after "chewed" and "spit" change the original meanings of the verbs. With them, the new meaning:

- a) is only softened.
- b) is stronger and more aggressive.
- c) of "chewed" is softened but of "spit" is strengthened.
- d) weakens the degree of sophistication to the original meaning.
- e) is completely different from the original.

Escola Superior de Propaganda e Marketing

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INGL**Questão 46**

In the sentence: ***Not all products lend themselves to that***, boldfaced in the text, the verb ***lend*** conveys another meaning, different from the most common one. It is:

- a) give.
- b) suit.
- c) add.
- d) confer.
- e) supply.

Conscious Consumerism: Slow vs. Fast Fashion & Upcycling



Agatha "Agy" is a textile artist and environmentalist. She co-founded Connected Threads Asia and Fashion Revolution Singapore to bring greater awareness to the environmental impact of the fashion industry. Her current goal is to get people to reconnect with their clothes through techniques such as repairing and transforming them into creative wearables (a.k.a. upcycling).

It was the realization that my wardrobe was starting to look like an archaeological dig and contributing to the heaps of textile and leather waste being incinerated each year, that I felt action was needed.

Each garment has passed through so many hands and countries before reaching your wardrobe, and so it is all about respecting and valuing the makers who made the piece of clothing.

You could call what I do "slow clothing", the antithesis to "fast fashion", which has now taken over our malls. Fast fashion churns out collections every two weeks, taking advantage of low labour costs and their extensive logistics network.

Manufacturing so many clothes to entice people to buy them not only creates a burden on our environment, but disconnects people from the garments they wear. It also causes people to lose touch with the skills needed to make clothing.



Yesterday misunderstands what made the Beatles so popular

By Noah Berlatsky

*The film **Yesterday** has an intriguing premise: What if the Beatles never existed? Unsuccessful, moderately talented singer-songwriter Jack Malik wakes up one day and is the only one who remembers the Beatles' songs. Suddenly he can pose as the creator of the greatest music ever written. As a result, he quickly becomes a world-renowned superstar.*

Jack is successful because the Beatles' songs, removed from their original context, still maintain the universal, instant appeal that has canonized them in our non-fictional world, offscreen. Label execs, other musicians, and huge numbers of fans are all won over by "Jack's" music; Even decades after the Soviet Union disintegrated, "Back in the USSR" still rocks people's world.

*But would "Back in the USSR" really be an automatic, surefire hit if it were released today, into a music scene whose interests have evolved far beyond the Beatles? Is quality in the arts so transcendent that it can overcome all differences of era, culture, and **happenstance**? Is music a meritocracy — an art form that privileges natural talent over everything else?*

There's good reason to believe that the answer to all three of those questions is no. Wonderful songs aren't always hits; talented musicians don't always achieve success commensurate with their abilities.

And sometimes a twist of fate lands the less talented in a position to reap massive rewards.

We tend to expect that good things don't always come to the most deserving people. Sometimes the most successful people get that way because they're in the right place at the right time, or know the right people, or were even born into it. And art is no exception.

There's research to back up the notion that fame and fortune come from more than pure talent. Sociologists Matthew Salganik of Princeton and Duncan Watts of Microsoft have conducted a number of studies to determine what makes a song popular. They discovered that when someone approaches a song knowing only that it's popular and well-liked within the cultural mass, that person is more inclined to come away liking the song too. This can create a ripple effect, with songs becoming more and more popular because they already are popular. Salganik and Watts's research suggests that the more visible something is the more highly regarded it is, and the more popular it is likely to become.

Social influence has a powerful effect on which songs become popular. As art is a form of communication we often share and experience socially, it makes sense that we like art that we believe will connect us to others.

Our instincts to spread what we like, and to like what others like, mean that what seem like small advantages for a song — perhaps a well-placed promo on Spotify, or appearing on the soundtrack of a Netflix show — can lead to a big chart presence. A good review at the right time or being used in a viral meme on a slow news day could help more people discover a song just out of happenstance. Songs that get an initial bump can ride that wave, so more people seek them out, buy them, and boost their popularity. This cycle can lead to one song, good or not, becoming a hit, while another disappears into obscurity.

The Beatles were very good by most qualitative metrics. But the band's quantitative achievements don't mean they are indisputably the most meritorious musicians of all time, or even of their day. More likely, the band **also** managed to be in the right place at the right time, on top of everything else.

Western racial inequalities also stymied many homegrown artists. Influential African American singers and girl groups like the Shirelles didn't have much opportunity to turn their Billboard hits into widespread celebrity and lasting cultural recognition. Paul McCartney and John Lennon are household names, but there aren't many casual music fans who know the name of the Shirelles' lead singer, Shirley Owens.

The Beatles were white, male English speakers who were able to tour and didn't die young. But they had other advantages as well. Perhaps most obviously, they were working in a genre that was broadly popular.

By contrast, today's most popular music is split between contemporary hip-hop and dance music that relies on synthesizers, electronics, and myriad cross-genre references. Pure rock 'n' roll, built on a simple four-person setup of guitar, bass, drums, and vocals, is no longer the dominant genre. "If a Beatles song came out today, it would sound dated," Charlie Harding, host of Vox's **Switched on Pop** podcast, told me. "There are hardly any synthesizers. It's all live drumming. Plus, so much of their music is blues-based, and blues-based music just isn't popular right now."

At their height, the Beatles famously pushed boundaries in the studio, creating psychedelic effects and soundscapes that no one at the time had ever heard before. But that's old hat in 2019. You can do all of what the Beatles did and more in your room with a laptop, at least technically speaking.

Sure, it's fun to think, as **Yesterday** does, that our love for the Beatles is universal, true, and incontrovertible. Where's the harm in that?

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The problem is that people often don't see the myth of meritocracy as a myth; they really believe in it. And when they do, it can have some unfortunate effects. The myth of meritocracy can make us less willing to invest in the collective good.

If we convince ourselves that talented artists like the Beatles will be successful no matter what, we can also convince ourselves that we don't really need to provide people with safety nets or resources. After all, the best will win out anyway. Why invest in school arts programs, or fund arts grants, if great musicians will be just fine on their own?

*The Beatles made wonderful, undoubtedly influential art. But if **Yesterday** weren't so hypnotized by the supposedly unmatched quality of the Beatles' music, it might be able to see that there are great songs being written by people like Jack Malik too. The film believes that songs like "Yesterday" are just so good, they would become mega-popular under any circumstances. And yet many people who think "Yesterday" is the best song ever have been inevitably swayed by the Beatles' popularity and legacy, the song's quality aside.*

Maybe instead, the best song ever is one we haven't heard yet; maybe it's the one you're going to write. Part of what happens when we abandon the myth of meritocracy is that we're better able to see the merit all around us. And that gives everyone a greater chance at success.

(adapted from <https://www.vox.com>, Jun 29, 2019)

Questão 42

The word **happenstance**, boldface in paragraph 4, can be replaced by all words below, except:

- a) luck
- b) coincidence
- c) fortuity
- d) chance
- e) success

Questão 48

The phrasal verbs **make up**, **fork over**, **lure (someone) in**, **miss out** and **set up**, all **boldfaced in the text**, mean, respectively:

- a) form, render, entice, lose, establish.
 - b) entice, render, form, lose, establish.
 - c) establish, form, render, lose, entice.
-

Partnership: 40 Years in the Making

China-Iran partnership. Understanding that history
context for the relationship today.

By Satgin Hamrah* and Alexander Eliassen**

December 04, 2021



China's growing influence, coupled with its Belt and Road Initiative (BRI), have major strategic implications as Beijing seeks to link its economic, geostrategic and security interests. Nowhere is this more evident than in its relationship with Iran, as it helps China enhance its points of interest and link the Middle East, Central, and South Asia together. It also gives Iran a much-needed boost to its worrying economic situation as its population continues to grapple with financial and public health challenges. The growth of the China-Iran relationship established during the Iran-Iraq War will not only reshape the political landscape of the Middle East, it will also strengthen each government's position within their respective country.

How this was done is very important. China's pragmatic post-Maoist leaders used the Iran-Iraq War to enter the

international arms market and cultivated strategic diplomatic relations with key regional players. However, its reach extended beyond the arms market, especially with Iran, as Beijing established the groundwork for a long-term relationship. Interestingly, while the Chinese government had expressed concern over the Iran-Iraq War and stated China's strict neutrality with the conflict, Beijing also strategically utilized the war to its advantage, maintaining relationships with both sides as it lay the foundation for its later endeavors. This approach allowed China to develop relationships with both Iran and Iraq.

China-Iran relations were also essential from an economic perspective, their trade relationship was so extensive that Iran became China's number one trading partner in the entire Middle East. This mutually beneficial relationship was extremely important for Iran as it grappled with issues related to the war and other economic and political challenges.

Given their 40-plus year relationship, China and Iran believe in the strength and durability of their partnership and sustained cooperation working toward their mutual interests. While rapprochement between the two countries grew gradually out of wartime necessity and economic needs, their increased diplomatic ties helped foster a strategic relationship that today is vividly clear in Iran's recently-approved bid to join the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO), the 25-year strategic agreement between Iran and China, and Iran's participation in China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI). Each aspect of this agreement is directly linked to the goals and strategic intentions of Xi Jinping's BRI, as Iran's centrality in the Middle East and political power in the region will prove vital to the initiative's success. In its current state, the China-Iran partnership is integral to both sides: to China, it represents the progression of the BRI in the Middle East, and to Iran it is the key to the success of a heavily sanctioned Iranian economy.

Some Iranians have been cautious in their view of Iran's relationship with China, arguing that it is more beneficial to China than Iran. Some have gone further, equating it with the 1813 Treaty of Gulistan and 1828 Treaty of Turkmenchay, under which Iran ceded parts of its territory in the Caucasus to Russia. These treaties have become a symbol of defeat to many Iranians. Nonetheless, Iran's relationship with China, including the recent cooperation agreement is a win for Iran. It will likely strengthen the country on multiple levels, including its negotiations with the U.S. and others in the long term.

Given the extension and scale of influence that this relationship has on Iran, China, and the region it is important to understand its modern context. Unpacking the influence of the Iran-Iraq War on current trends and Iran's and China's long game, is an important facet in developing a comprehensive conceptual framework of the current landscape.

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Disponível em: <https://thediplomat.com/2021/12/the-china-iran-strategic-partnership-40-years-in-the-making/>; Acesso em: 18 Jan 2022 (adaptado)

Questão 44

The expression '*in the making*' in the title of the article points to:

- a) a cooperation in progress for decades.
- b) a partnership ended in the 1980's.
- c) a frustrated attempt of understanding.
- d) the construction of Chinese factories in Iran.
- e) a threat of conflict between Middle Eastern and Asian countries.

Drink Up, Japan Tells Young People

The country's tax agency, hoping to revitalize the economy, is holding a contest to encourage drinking.



TOKYO — Among the casualties of the pandemic is one that many young people in Japan say they do not miss: the drinking culture.

Sobriety, they have decided after two years of less socializing and nightcrawling, has its advantages. And that's why a new message from the Japanese government — drink up! — seems to be putting few in the spirit.

To bolster its ailing alcohol industry, Japan's National Tax Agency has kicked off a contest inviting those ages 20 to 39 to submit ideas for encouraging people to consume more alcohol. It named the project after the national beverage: "Sake Viva!"

People. I'll Pass, Many Reply.

verse the alcohol industry's pandemic
urage more drinking among the young.

By Hikari Hida and John Yoon
Aug. 19, 2022



The agency says it hopes to “revitalize the industry” with the contest, whose winner is to be selected in a tournament later this year. But its **entreaty** is clashing with more than two years of actions by the government, which discouraged alcohol sales at restaurants and bars and put up signs forbidding drinking in parks and in the streets.

With Japan reaching new highs in coronavirus infections, including over 255,000 new cases on Thursday, many young people are wondering why the government is now saying it's OK to go out and drink.

“The media is announcing record Covid cases, while restaurants are like, don't talk while eating, wear a mask,” said

Chika Kato, a 27-year-old consultant in Tokyo. "But the government is at the same time asking us to go all out and drink."

"It's an **awkward** situation," she added. "Who do I listen to?"

To some, any official encouragement to drink — pandemic or not — is a bad idea.

"I don't think it is a good thing to make people who don't drink, drink," said Mima Matsumaru, 25, who works in advertising. After using the pandemic as a chance to stop drinking, she said she didn't miss it very much anyway.

None of the Japanese alcohol makers have signed on to the initiative. But bar owners praised it.

In Ginza, one of Tokyo's popular nightlife districts, the pubs remained dimly lit and mostly quiet on Thursday night. "I hope this helps Ginza come alive again," said Kenta Kobayashi, 34, a bartender who has seen a drastic drop in sales since the pandemic began.

On average, people in Japan drank about 20 gallons of alcohol in 2020, down from 26 gallons in 1995, according to government data. The decline has hurt lucrative tax revenues: Levies on alcohol accounted for 1.7 percent of Japan's tax revenue (about \$8 billion) in 2020, down from 3 percent in 2011 and 5 percent in 1980.

Under the Japan tax agency's contest, participants may propose new products and designs targeting young people, even sales techniques involving artificial intelligence or the metaverse. As long as submissions are written in Japanese, they may come from anywhere. The winning entry will be commercialized.

The contest's organizers said that overindulgence was not the goal, adding that people should drink only "the appropriate amount" and take "common sense" measures against contracting the virus. "We are in no way promoting excessive drinking among young people," said Ryo Tsukamoto, a spokesman for the agency's alcohol tax division.

But critics worried about unintended consequences. Hidetomi Tanaka, an economist, called the effort an "irresponsible and unorthodox drinking campaign." About one million Japanese suffer from alcoholism, while about 9.8 million others are potentially addicted, according to research by the Japanese Health Ministry.

*Worldwide, the pandemic has brought down alcohol consumption among younger adults. In South Korea, consumption of soju dropped by 14 percent from 2019 to 2020 and beer consumption by 23 percent, leading to the nation's lowest revenue in alcohol taxes in 10 years. In the United States, the prevalence of **binge** drinking among young adults surveyed dropped to 26 percent in 2020, after remaining at about 30 percent from 2015 to 2019, a study showed.*

Neither country's government has gone as far as to promote drinking. In France, though, lawmakers once considered promoting wine consumption when wine exports and domestic sales fell off the table in 2004. Included in their recommendations was a program encouraging young people to "educate their tastes."

Disponível em: <https://www.nytimes.com/2022/08/19/world/asia/japan-alcohol-contest.html>.

Acesso em 30/08/2022

Questão 45

**doldrums, ailing, entreaty,
awkward, binge**

The meanings of the words above,
boldfaced in the article, are, respectively:

- a) Stagnation, flawed, request, unenviable, spree.
- b) Activity, healthy, summon, desirable, moderate.
- c) Flawed, unenviable, request, stagnation, spree.
- d) Summon, healthy, activity, desirable, moderate.
- e) Stagnation, healthy, request, desirable, spree.

China Has Leapfrogged the U.S. in Key Technologies. Can a New Law Help?

While Congress argued over whether
and how to support American
chip makers and research in other
technologies, China was surging ahead.

July 28, 2022

(1) In the weeks before the House and the Senate ended 13 months of arguments and passed the \$280 billion CHIPS and Science Act, China's main, state-supported chip maker cleared a major technological barrier that delivered a bit of a shock to the world.

(2) Experts are still assessing how China apparently leapfrogged ahead in its effort to manufacture a semiconductor whose circuits are of such tiny dimensions — about 10,000 times thinner than a human hair — that they rival those made in Taiwan, which supplies both China and the West. The Biden administration has gone to extraordinary lengths to keep the highly specialized equipment to make those chips out of Chinese hands, because progress in chip manufacturing is now scrutinized as a way to define national power — much the same way nuclear tests or precision-guided missiles were during a previous cold war.

(3) No one yet knows whether China can exploit the breakthrough on a large scale; that may take years. But one lesson seemed clear: While Congress debated and amended and argued over whether and how to support American chip makers and a broad range of research in other technologies — from advanced batteries to robotics and quantum computing — China was surging ahead, betting it would take Washington years to get its act together.

(4) "Our Congress is working at political speed," said Eric Schmidt, the former Google chief executive who went on to lead the National Security Commission on Artificial Intelligence, which warned last year of the huge dangers of falling far behind in a "foundational" technology like advanced semiconductor manufacturing in a world of vulnerable supply chains. "The Chinese government is working at commercial speed."

(5) In China, the drive to catch up and manufacture the most advanced chips is part of the "Made in China 2025" program. That effort began in 2015. While few in Congress want to concede the point, the technologies that the United States will be funding largely replicate the Chinese list. And 2025 isn't very far away, meaning the money will just get flowing while Chinese and other competitors move on to their next set of goals. Meanwhile, the American semiconductor industry has **withered**, to the point where none of the most advanced chips are made in the United States, even though the fundamental technology was born here and gave Silicon Valley its name.

(6) None of this means American competitiveness is doomed. Just as Japan once seemed as if it was the 10-foot-tall technological giant in the late 1980s and early 1990s, but then missed some of the biggest breakthroughs in mobile computing and Windows operating systems and even chip-making, China is discovering that money alone does not guarantee technological dominance. But it helps.

(7) It has taken the American Congress far longer to come to the same conclusion. Still, China has turned out to be one of the few issues on which Republicans and Democrats can come together — the bill passed the House 243 to 187, with one abstention.

Questão 48

The word “**withered**” used in the sentence:
*“Meanwhile, the American semiconductor industry has **withered**, to the point where none of the most advanced chips are made in the United States, even though the fundamental technology was born here and gave Silicon Valley its name”* (paragraph 5) can be replaced by:

- a) skyrocketed.
- b) slightly decreased.
- c) significantly developed.
- d) disappeared completely.
- e) become smaller.

A Chinese app conquered the planet - and now the U.S. is threatening to shut it down. Can the world's biggest virality machine survive?

By Alex W. Palmer, Dec. 20, 2022

On March 10, two weeks after Russia's invasion of Ukraine, the White House convened a Zoom call with 30 prominent TikTok creators. Jen Psaki, then the White House press secretary, and members of the National Security Council staff briefed the creators, who together had tens of millions of followers, on the latest news from the conflict and the White House's goals and priorities. The meeting followed a similar effort the previous summer, in which the White House recruited dozens of TikTokers to help encourage young people to get vaccinated against Covid.

The app had only become more popular in the intervening months. "We recognize this is a critically important avenue in the way the American public is finding out about the latest," the White House director of digital strategy, Rob Flaherty, told the assembled group. "So we wanted to make sure you had the latest information from an authoritative source." Yet at the same time, the Biden administration was more than a year into negotiations with ByteDance, the Chinese company that created and owns TikTok, about national security concerns surrounding the app. In fact, the White House staff members who organized and briefed the TikTok creators were barred from downloading the app on their work phones.

The administration's contradictory approach to TikTok — its embrace of the app as a vital conduit to the public, and its fear of the app as a potential tool of foreign influence — is perhaps a fitting

response to the utterly unique problem that TikTok poses. Seemingly overnight, TikTok has managed to remake American culture both low and high, from media and music to memes and celebrity, in its own image. TikTok turned Olivia Rodrigo into a household name and propelled the author Colleen Hoover to the top of the best-seller list, with more copies sold this year than the Bible. TikTok coined "quiet quitting," one of the hallmark phrases of 2022, and introduced a whole new dialect of algospeak — "seggs," "unalive," "le dollar bean" — that is now spreading across pop culture. Corporations and brands, from Goldfish crackers to Prada, have redirected billions of dollars worth of advertising to the platform in recognition of its all-encompassing reach, which can, at seemingly any moment, turn even a decades-old product into a must-have item. Last year, TikTok had more site visits than Google, and more watch minutes in the United States than YouTube. Facebook took almost nine years to reach one billion users; TikTok did it in five.

The app's extraordinary success is made even more remarkable by the fact that it is a product of America's greatest political rival. Despite decades of trying, no Chinese company has ever conquered American society like TikTok. It's difficult to imagine a Russian or Iranian company — or, increasingly, even another Chinese company — pulling off a similar feat. TikTok's provenance has stoked persistent and long standing worries about its vulnerability to exploitation and manipulation by the Chinese government. Over the last year in particular, TikTok has faced an unceasing stream of bad press, with each week seeming to bring a fresh revelation about the company's questionable data practices and spotty internal safeguards. In just the last six months, TikTok and ByteDance have been accused of lying about the access of China-based employees to American user

data, using a news app to push pro-Beijing content abroad and allowing Chinese state media accounts to run unchecked and unlabeled as they criticized the American political process.

If TikTok's popularity has thus far provided it some insulation against government action, the app's time may be running out. In November, Brendan Carr, a commissioner of the F.C.C., said it should be banned outright. Senator Mark Warner, co-chairman of the Senate Select Committee on Intelligence, said of a ban, **"The sooner we bite the bullet, the better."** Christopher Wray, director of the F.B.I., told Congress he was "extremely concerned" about TikTok's operations in the United States. Earlier this month, Senator Marco Rubio introduced legislation that would effectively prevent TikTok from operating in the United States by banning all apps "subject to substantial influence" by China, Russia and other foreign adversaries.

The Biden administration, meanwhile, is said to be nearing a deal with TikTok. Speaking at a conference of tech leaders, Kemba Walden, the principal deputy national cyber director, said that the White House had not made any final decision on a ban, but voiced support for "any measure that will raise security." Maryland, South Dakota, South Carolina, Nebraska, Texas, Alabama and Utah have already banned use of the app on state devices. A bill passed by the U.S. Senate last week would do the same at the federal level. The military has also barred the app from government devices.

In the United States, being tough on China is one of the few areas of bipartisan agreement. And in this fraught geopolitical context, TikTok is considered a Trojan horse — for Chinese influence, for spying, or possibly both. In China, meanwhile, government regulation has sought to control ambitious tech companies and their founders, out of fear that, with their influence,

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independence and popularity, they were becoming alternative power bases to the Chinese Communist Party. TikTok itself is not available in China — users there must access **Douyin**, a different ByteDance app, which follows Chinese government directives on censorship and propaganda.

Just a few years ago, the rise of ByteDance seemed like an announcement of an era of Chinese app dominance. Indeed, it would be hard to find a company more self-consciously modeled, in both spirit and substance, on America's tech giants. ByteDance's founder internalized the mythos of Silicon Valley, taking to heart the idea, long promoted by Washington, that the American market was the ultimate prize, and that it welcomed any entrepreneur with the talent and ambition to succeed. But now, with walls going up on both sides of the Pacific, TikTok seems likely to be the last of its kind as well as the first. The company is caught in the middle between the old era and the new — too Chinese for America, too American for China.

Disponível em <https://www.nytimes.com/2022/12/20/magazine/tiktok-us-china-diplomacy.html>.

Acesso em 18/01/2023

the video is an opportunity to show a certain... can be...
(questions 41-44) because:

- a) It reveals the population's support for the American-European conflict;
- b) It shows the population's opposition to the American-European conflict;
- c) It suggests how adults can convince adolescents;
- d) It makes fun of people who expose themselves;
- e) It mentions the possibility of the restriction being imposed by the U.S.A.

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- c) To face the situation;
- d) To shoot a weapon;
- e) To make something popular.

Questão 43

The idiom used by the senator in the sentence "*The sooner we bite the bullet, the better.*" (**boldfaced in the article**) means:

- a) To surrender;
 - b) To hide from;
-

Can Nature Lie?

The lying that we humans **do** requires a more sophisticated kind of cognition than a bird, flower, or fungus can muster.

By Robin Marantz Henig



*Analyzing animals to better understand Homo sapiens has become a sub-genre in the field of science writing. Sometimes this works well, as when Sabrina Imbler uses a purple octopus, starving to death while incubating her eggs, as a metaphor for disordered eating in *How Far the Light Reaches*. But other times, the enterprise feels downright Procrustean: An author amasses a wide swath of animal activities, even down to the level of the cell, and describes them in ways that might give the impression that some human quality has an analogue out there in the biosphere.*

*The compression is most strained when the activity being explained is complex and quintessentially human, such as deception. This makes the enterprise of writing *The Liars of Nature* and the *Nature of Liars*, a recent book by Lixing Sun, especially difficult. Sun, a professor of animal behavior, ecology, and evolution at Central Washington University, presents a string of entertaining facts about the many ways plants and animals use trickery to survive. But the language is too casually anthropomorphic, undermining the points he's trying to make about cheating in the natural world. At the outset, Sun acknowledges that ascribing intentionality to animal behavior is "neither easy nor*

necessary," and admits that deceptive adaptations arise from the unplanned march of evolution. "Cheating flourishes in nature as a direct result of natural selection," he writes. It also "serves as a potent selective force that drives evolution on its own." But his word choices and awkward phrasing often leave the reader with only a partial understanding of how flora and fauna actually "lie" and "deceive."

The behavior we think of as lying requires a more sophisticated kind of cognition than telling the truth does—and certainly a more sophisticated kind of cognition than a bird, flower, or fungus can muster. Years ago, when I was reporting an article about the science of deception, the psychologist Paul Ekman told me that a liar needs three qualities to succeed: the ability to think strategically, like a good chess player; the ability to read the needs of others, like a talented therapist; and the ability to manage emotions, like a grown-up. In other words, a good liar needs a high level of both cognitive and emotional intelligence.

And though lying—at least in humans—might be an ingenious skill, the evolution through which cheating arises in the natural world is not smart in the least. The way Sun describes each example makes it seem that plants and animals develop particular traits of fakery or mimicry out of some sort of mischievous, cunning impulse. But there's nothing deliberate about evolutionary adaptation, which is the perpetuation of traits, arising randomly, that improve an organism's chance of staying alive, reproducing, and passing along the same advantageous traits to the next generation. It's a stupid process, lacking not only intentionality but also any kind of end goal beyond helping a particular organism survive and reproduce.

Sun knows this; he's a biology professor, after all. But the diction he deploys suggest otherwise. Sun, like others, falls into the science-writing trap of stretching biological phenomena to

fit the contours of human understanding. As a result, the reader can be forgiven for coming away with the impression that cheating fauna and flora—right down to the level of bacteria—are clever enough to always have, as he puts it in one of his many awkward attempts to be engaging, a few new “tricks up their sleeves.”

His colorful word choices—no doubt employed to make his writing more accessible and fun—seem to elide randomness altogether. He uses terms such as imposters, hustlers, and con artists to describe the book’s animals, including Pacific tree frogs, and talks of the “tricks” that were “invented” by the duplicitous cuckoo. He uses words like these to characterize cheats that don’t even have nervous systems, such as the South American passion flower. It has evolved spots on its leaves that resemble the eggs of the Heliconius butterfly, which cause the butterfly to avoid laying its clutch there and instead move on to a plant that looks unoccupied—a handy deflection, what Sun calls a “most peculiar form of plant mimicry,” because newly hatched Heliconius caterpillars can be quite destructive to the passion flower. As Sun chooses to describe it, those yellow spots arose because “these plants can ‘read the mind’ of Heliconius butterflies.” But in truth, no plant ESP is involved; those fake-out butterfly eggs are the result of a random mutation in leaf coloration that turned out to have a benefit for the mutant plant. And using scare quotes around “read the mind” doesn’t get the author off the hook.

If you’re looking for a compilation of weird facts about the splendors of the natural world—something that’s been called the “gee-whiz” approach to science writing—this book delivers. It is an often-enlightening collection of some stunning acts of animal trickery that have evolved in the brutal Darwinian struggle for survival. Dropping some of the tidbits you picked up here would make you the hit of the cocktail party. Did you know, for instance, that the stripes of a zebra create a confusing effect called “razzle dazzle,” and that their advantage may be in keeping away tsetse flies?

*In the last chapters of the book, Sun tries to draw a straight line from these many organisms to humans. We can, he writes, "use our newly acquired evolutionary understanding of how cheaters operate to design novel strategies to combat cheating in our society." Sun's desire to draw lessons from the natural world about human lies has a subtler danger: Other living things are not just furry or feathery little proto-people, and comparing their behavior to ours risks underappreciating them as the amazing organisms they are. The astounding variety of the biosphere, evolved through random mutations over the course of eons, is reason enough to marvel at all the ways that certain surprising conduct has helped plants and animals thrive. So my recommendation is to read *The Liars of Nature* and the *Nature of Liars* for its great cocktail-party fodder, and to leave lessons about human deception to the psychologists, neuroscientists, and philosophers.*

Robin Marantz Henig is a freelance science writer whose books include *The Monk in the Garden*, *Pandora's Baby*, and *Twentysomething*.

<https://www.theatlantic.com/books/archive/2023/07/evolution-liars-of-nature-lixing-sun-review/674808/>
Acesso em 26/07/2023.

Questão 42

In the subtitle of the text, the verb **do** (boldfaced) could be best replaced by:

- a) lie;
- b) tell;
- c) say;
- d) make;
- e) engage in.

GEN Z NEVER LEARNED TO READ CURSIVE

How will they interpret the past?

By Drew Gilpin Faust

(1) *It was a good book, the student told the 14 others in the undergraduate seminar I was teaching, and it included a number of excellent illustrations, such as photographs of relevant Civil War manuscripts. But, he continued, those weren't very helpful to him, because of course he couldn't read cursive.*

(2) **Had I heard** him correctly? Who else can't read cursive? I asked the class. The answer: about two-thirds. And who can't write it? Even more. What did they do about signatures? **They had invented** them by combining vestiges of whatever cursive instruction they may have had with creative squiggles and flourishes.

(3) In 2010, cursive was omitted from the new national Common Core standards for K–12 education. The students in my class, and their peers, were then somewhere in elementary school. **Handwriting instruction had already been declining** as laptops and tablets and lessons in “keyboarding” assumed an ever more prominent place in the classroom. Most of my students remembered getting no more than a year or so of somewhat desultory cursive training, which was often pushed aside by a growing emphasis on “teaching to the test.” Now in college, they represent the vanguard of a cursiveless world.

(4) Although I was unaware of it at the time, the 2010 **Common Core policy on cursive had generated** an uproar. Defenders of script argued variously that knowledge of cursive was “a basic right,” a key connection between hand and brain, an essential form of self-discipline, and a fundamental expression of identity. Its disappearance would represent a craven submission to “the tyranny of ‘relevance.’”

(5) Within a decade, cursive's **embattled** advocates had succeeded in passing measures requiring some

sort of cursive instruction in more than 20 states. At the same time, the struggle for cursive became part of a growing, politicized nostalgia for a lost past. In 2016, Louisiana's state senators reminded their constituents that **the Declaration of Independence had been written** in cursive and cried out "America!" as they unanimously voted to restore handwriting instruction across the state.

(6) Yet the decline in cursive seems inevitable. Writing is, after all, a technology, and most technologies are sooner or later surpassed and replaced.

(7) By the turn of the 20th century, the typewriter had become sufficiently established to prompt the first widespread declarations of the obsolescence of handwriting. But it would be a long demise. In 1956, *Look* magazine pronounced handwriting "out-of-date," yet cursive still claimed a secure place in the curriculum for decades.

(8) Given a current generation of students in which so few can read or write cursive, one cannot assume it will ever again serve as an effective form of communication. I asked my students about the implications of what they had told me, focusing first on their experience as students. No, most of these history students admitted, they could not read manuscripts.

(9) I continued questioning: Didn't professors make handwritten comments on their papers and exams? Many of the students found these illegible. Sometimes they would ask a teacher to decipher the comments; more often they just ignored them. Most faculty, especially after the remote instruction of the pandemic, now grade online. But I wondered how many of my colleagues have been dutifully offering handwritten observations without any clue that they would never be read.

(10) What about handwriting in your personal lives? I went on. One student reported that he had to ask his parents to "translate" handwritten letters from his grandparents. I asked the students if they made grocery lists, kept journals, or wrote

thank-you or condolence letters. Almost all said yes. Almost all said they did so on laptops and phones or sometimes on paper in block letters.

(11) During my years as Harvard president, I regarded the handwritten note as a kind of superpower. I wrote hundreds of them and kept a pile of note cards in the upper-left-hand drawer of my desk. They provided a way to reach out and say: I am noticing you. This message of thanks or congratulations or sympathy comes not from some staff person or some machine but directly from me. I touched it and hope it touches you. Now I wonder how many recipients of these messages could not read them.

(12) All of us, not just students and scholars, will be affected by cursive's loss. The inability to read handwriting deprives society of direct access to its own past. We will become reliant on a small group of trained translators and experts to report what history—including the documents and papers of our own families—was about. The spread of literacy in the early modern West was driven by people's desire to read God's word for themselves, to be empowered by an experience of unmediated connection. The abandonment of cursive represents a curious reverse parallel: We are losing a connection, and thereby disempowering ourselves.

(13) On the last day of class, a student came up to me with a copy of one of my books and asked me to sign it. I wrote an inscription that included not just his name and mine, but thanks for his many contributions to the seminar. Then I asked, a little wistfully, if he'd like me to read it to him.

Adapted from <https://www.theatlantic.com/magazine/archive/2022/10/gen-z-handwriting-teaching-cursive-history/671246/> Accessed on 31/01/2024.

Questão 47

The adjective **embattled**, boldfaced in the sentence “Within a decade, cursive’s **embattled** advocates had succeeded in

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passing measures requiring some sort of cursive instruction in more than 20 states." is formed with the addition of a prefix to the noun/verb form. A similar word formation occurs in all lexical items below, except:

- a) embodied
 - b) encouraged
 - c) endangered
 - d) entered
 - e) enslaved
-

'It is OK to be content with your simple life': is 'underconsumption core' the answer to too much shopping?

Influencers are pushing back against consumerism by encouraging followers to repair or repurpose their stuff. But is this 'trend' just what many people call normal life?

Sara Radin
7 Aug 2024

- (1) *"This is your daily reminder that most of the content you see online is not the way most people live," says sustainability influencer Sabrina Pare, in a video she posted to her 250,000 TikTok followers recently. "It is OK to be content with your simple life," she continues as she makes her bed. "It is not normal to do massive clothing hauls, daily trips to Target and have a new outfit every day. **Nor** do I think it should be aspirational."*
- (2) *It is one of a slew of videos that are surfacing online of people making a point of using and appreciating what they already have, or what they find on online hand-me-down groups, rather than showing new clothes acquired on the daily from Amazon or the next Stanley cup accessory, or the latest Dyson hairdryer. It's all part of a trend aiming to encourage people to reconsider how much they consume – say hello to underconsumption core.*
- (3) *Also called normal core or normal consumption, the movement is about taking on an attitude of mindfulness and "less is more" at a time when overconsumption is rife and TikTok is full of content encouraging users to buy things they don't need. Pare, who goes by @sabrina.sustainable.life on TikTok, says underconsumption core videos show items that "might not be the newest, but still work". Underconsumption core influencers, she says, are "showing items they have upcycled, ways they reduce waste, and*

things they have gotten second hand. It's all about extending the life of your items, reducing the number of items you own, and being mindful of your purchases." Pare has been posting frequently about underconsumption core since the middle of July, which is when she says she began seeing it popping off on TikTok. It follows the deinfluencing movement, which started last year and encouraged consumers not to buy anything. Now, creators are proudly showing the use and reuse of everyday items and clothes they've had for years. In another of her recent videos, Pare shows how to extend the lifespan of your knives. It's not the most glamorous or compelling content on social media, but Pare's videos have amassed nearly 15m likes.

- (4) Amid new "cores" popping up every day, which encourage mass consumption, underconsumption core is **tongue in cheek**. "The irony lies in the fact that underconsumption is a practice, while 'core' refers to an aesthetic," says trend creator and **Depop** trend specialist Agus Panzoni. How can you under consume when there is no codified amount you are meant to consume? And what does it matter what consuming less looks like – the point of the movement is surely in the doing, rather than what that looks like aesthetically?
- (5) According to Shanu Walpita, a trend forecaster who teaches in the communications department at London College of Fashion, "underconsumption core is a memetic antithesis to a consumerist hype cycle we have become accustomed to". It's a viral rebranding of conscious consumerism where people are flexing "luxe" slowness. Beyond this, it reflects a growing shift in consumer behaviour. "People want to lower the quantity of clothing they've purchased and focus on sustainable, and mindful purchasing habits," says Panzoni.

- (6) Underconsumption core is driven by several factors, including, "environmental awareness," she says. "The spotlight that has been put on fast fashion and its damaging impacts, as well as the global increase in desire to buy second hand. According to Walpita, **defluencing**, **defashioning** and other de/core buzzwords have been hinting at this shift in consumer mindset for a while now. "Consumers are celebrating minimalism as a form of activism," she says.
- (7) But good intentions and "doing better" to one side, "there's no denying acute financial and economical constraints play a part in the advancement of this trend," says Walpita. As people have less money, many have had to foster more of a make-do-and-mend mindset.
- Critics have been quick to highlight that the tenets of underconsumption core are nothing new. _____ Pare says it feels good to see others posting the kind of content she has always shared – "I love this trend. I love to see how widespread it has become and how many people are participating." – she also points out that "lower-income individuals have been doing many of the things that are shown in these videos for ages". But rather than glamorising a certain way of living, she believes underconsumption core is normalising the way many people already live. "I think of my immigrant grandparents who don't waste a crumb of food. They would be very happy to see this trend," she says.
- (8) Walpita points to the ethical implications of underconsumption core. "It would be iffy to not acknowledge the fetishisation or glamorisation of poverty and class hierarchy," she says. "The irony is that there is an element of privilege to choosing to actively lean into underconsumption and turn it into a form of viral, sharable content." She says there's also little acknowledgment of the fact that this viewpoint negates the communities, such as those in the global south, where these practices are common (and not necessarily linked to poverty or class) – rather, they are cultural necessities and signifiers of care.

- (9) *"A lot of people are responding [to the trend] by saying this is what it is like being working class," says Georgina Johnson, editor of The Slow Grind: Practising Hope and Imagination, an intersectional environmentalist anthology. According to Johnson, underconsumption core is missing cultural and racial nuance. In her experience, she has seen many trends besides underconsumption core take off that she considers to be inherently Black – "we haven't had so much so we've learned to reuse things." Still, she thinks it can be a positive thing. "It's just about how it's contextualised and who is given visibility around it."*
- (10) *While Panzoni believes there are some positive implications, highlighting the way the trend promotes owning fewer possessions, she also understands why people might take issue with the way it "glamorises the experience of those who don't have the means to not engage in underconsumption core." But, she says, in the era of Temu and Shein, where new clothing and household items can be found at incredibly low prices, there's a net positive in a trend that encourages us to appreciate the look of quality, well-used products.*
- (11) *It speaks to a wider cultural shift, with people looking for ways out of mass consumerism. "People are starting to realise that consumerism can make us feel lonely because it pushes us to seek fulfillment and happiness in material possessions, rather than meaningful relationships," says Pare. "Many people buy things for fulfillment, but those feelings don't tend to last long, so then they buy something again, and it's a vicious endless cycle of consumption." True happiness, she says, comes from diving into hobbies and passions, spending time with loved ones and being involved in your community – not from Stanley cups and viral hairdryers.*

Adapted from [theguardian.com](https://www.theguardian.com).

Available at <https://www.theguardian.com/fashion/article/2024/aug/07/it-is-ok-to-be-content-with-your-simple-life-is-underconsumption-core-the-answer-to-too-much-shopping>. Accessed on 01/10/2024

Questão 43

The terms 'depop', 'defluencing' and 'de-fashioning' boldfaced in the article :

- a) are buzzwords created by the author of the article.
- b) refer to shifts in the mindset of social media users.
- c) refer to the decline of modish behaviors in digital platforms.
- d) define the aspirations of environmentalists and other activists.
- e) are unethical behaviors displayed by digital influencers.

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Questão 46

In paragraph 4, the writer uses an idiom: **tongue in cheek** (boldfaced in the article). This idiom is used when something is intended as a joke, though seeming or appearing serious. In the article, it is used to explain that:

- a) the underconsumption core is not meant to be taken seriously.
- b) the underconsumption core is not meant to be taken ironically.
- c) differently from the other 'cores', the underconsumption core shouldn't be seen as a trend.
- d) core refers to visual aspects, whereas underconsumption refers to implementing a practice.
- e) the whole movement is meant to romanticize a real situation that would otherwise be seen as dramatic.

Caffeine's Dirty Little Secret

"How much is too much?" is an impossible question.

By Yasmin Tayag



Illustration by Ben Kothe / The Atlantic. Source: Getty.

JANUARY 26, 2024

(1) On Tuesday, curiosity finally got the best of me. How potent could Panera's Charged Lemonades really be? Within minutes of my first sip of the hyper-caffeinated drink in its strawberry-lemon-mint flavor, I understood why memes have likened it to an illicit drug. My vision sharpened; sweat slicked my palms.

(2) Laced with more caffeine than a typical energy drink, Panera's Charged Lemonade has been implicated in two wrongful-death lawsuits since it was introduced in 2022. Though both customers who died had health issues that made them sensitive to caffeine, a third lawsuit this month alleges that **the lemonade gave an otherwise healthy 27-year-old lasting heart problems**. Following the second death, Panera denied that the drink was the cause, but in light of the lawsuits, it has added warnings about the drink, reduced its caffeine content, and removed the option for customers to serve themselves.

(3) *All the attention on Panera's Charged Lemonade has resurfaced an age-old question: How much caffeine is too much? You won't find a simple answer anywhere. Caffeine consumption is widely considered to be beneficial because it mostly is—boosting alertness, productivity, and even mood. But there is a point when guzzling caffeine tips over into uncomfortable, possibly unhealthy territory. The problem is that defining this point in discrete terms is virtually impossible. In the era of extreme caffeine, this is a dangerous way to live.*

(4) *Most people don't have to worry about dying after drinking a Charged Lemonade. The effects, though uncomfortable, usually seem to be minor. After drinking half of mine, I was so wired that I couldn't make sense of the thoughts ricocheting around my brain for the next few hours. Caffeine routinely leads to jitteriness, nervousness, sweating, insomnia, and rapid heartbeat. If mild, such symptoms can be well worth the benefits.*

(5) *But consuming too much caffeine can have serious health impacts. High doses—more than 1,000 milligrams a day—can result in a state of intoxication known as caffeinism. The symptoms can be severe: People can “develop seizures and life-threatening irregularities of the heartbeat,” and some die, David Juurlink, a toxicology professor at the University of Toronto who also works at the Ontario Poison Centre, told me.*

(6) *You're unlikely to ingest that much caffeine from beverages alone, yet the increasing availability of highly caffeinated products makes it more of a possibility than ever before. Besides Panera's Charged Lemonade, dozens of energy drinks contain similar amounts of caffeine, and some come in candy-inspired flavors such as Bubblicious and Sour Patch Kids. Less potent but highly snackable products include caffeinated coffee cubes, energy chews, marshmallows, mints, ice*

pops, and even vapes. Consumed quickly and in rapid succession, these foods can lead to potentially toxic caffeine intake "because your body hasn't had time to tell you to stop," Jennifer Temple, a professor at the University of Buffalo who studies caffeine use, told me.

(7) More than ever, we need a way to track our caffeine consumption, but we don't seem to have any good options. In all of the lawsuits against Panera, the basic argument is this: **Had the company more adequately warned customers of the drink's caffeine content, perhaps no one would have been hurt.** But most of us just aren't used to thinking about caffeine in numerical terms the way we do with calories and alcohol by volume (ABV). Caffeine intake is generally something that's not measured but experienced: I know, for example, that a double espresso from the office coffee machine will give me the shakes.

_____ I knew how much caffeine is in a Charged Lemonade, I had no idea how much of it I could drink before having the same reaction.

(8) Although people generally aren't aware of the amounts of caffeine they consume, they tend to develop a good sense of how much they can handle, Temple said. But usually, this knowledge is product-specific; when trying a new caffeine product, the effect can be hard to predict. Part of the problem is that the amount of caffeine in products varies dramatically, even among drinks that may seem similar: A 12-ounce Americano from McDonald's contains 71 milligrams of caffeine, but the same drink at Starbucks contains 150 milligrams. The caffeine in popular energy drinks ranges from 75 milligrams (Ocean Spray Cran-Energy) to 316 milligrams (Redline Xtreme), according to the Center for Science in the Public Interest.

(9) The reason we aren't good at thinking about caffeine is that historically, we've never really had to think that hard about it. Sure, one too many espressos might have occasionally put someone over

the edge, but caffeine was consumed and sold in amounts that didn't require as much thought or caution. "A generation ago, you didn't have all these energy drinks," so people didn't grow up learning about safe caffeine consumption the way they may have done for alcohol, Darin Detwiler, a food-policy expert at Northeastern University, told me.

(10) Nothing else in our daily diet is quite like caffeine. Certainly people **swear by** it, and its benefits are clear: Research shows that it can improve cognitive performance, speed up reaction time, and boost logical reasoning, and it may even reduce the risk of Parkinson's, diabetes, liver disease, and cancer. But for a substance so ubiquitous that it's called the most widely used drug in the world, our grasp of how to maximize its benefits is feeble at best. Even the most seasoned coffee drinkers sometimes unintentionally get too wired; as new, more highly caffeinated products become available, instances of caffeine drinkers overdoing it will probably become more common. Perhaps the best we can do is learn how much of each drink we can handle, one super-charged sip at a time.

Disponível em: <https://www.theatlantic.com/health/archive/2024/01/caffeine-how-much-charged-lemo-nade/677252/>. Acesso em 28/03/2024

Questão 48

The phrasal verb '**swear by**' boldfaced in paragraph 10 can be replaced by all the words below, except for:

- a) endorse;
- b) vouch for;
- c) advocate;
- d) praise;
- e) deny.

Text 1:

Brain Science Reveals Why Waking Up Can Be Such a Struggle

(By Katie Kavanagh & Nature magazine)

Neuroscientists have found that the brain can wake up in different ways, explaining why some mornings feel like a dream and some feel like a disaster

*How does your brain wake up from sleep? A study of more than 1,000 arousals from slumber has revealed precisely how the brain bestirs itself during the transition to alertness — a finding that might help to manage sleep inertia, the grogginess that many people feel when **hitting the snooze button**.*

Recordings of people as they woke from the dream-laden phase of sleep showed that the first brain regions to rouse are those associated with executive function and decision-making, located at the front of the head. A wave of wakefulness then spreads to the back, ending with an area associated with vision.

The findings could change how we think of waking up, says Rachel Rowe, a neuroscientist at the University of Colorado Boulder, who was not involved with the work. The results emphasize that “falling asleep and waking up aren’t simply reverse processes, but really waking up is this ordered wave of activation that moves from the front to the back of the brain”, whereas falling asleep seems to be less linear and more gradual.

The study was published today in Current Biology.

Sleeping-brain signature

The wide-awake brain shows a characteristic pattern of electrical activity, recorded by sensors on the scalp — it looks like a jagged line made up of small, tightly packed peaks and valleys. Although the pattern looks similar during rapid eye movement (REM) sleep,

when vivid dreams occur, this stage features a lack of skeletal-muscle movement. The peaks are taller during most stages of non-REM sleep, which ranges from light to very deep slumber.

Scientists already knew that the 'awakened' signature occurs at different times in different brain regions, but common imaging techniques did not allow these patterns to be explored on a precise timescale.

To refine the understanding of awakening, Francesca Siclari, a neuroscientist at the Netherlands Institute for Neuroscience in Amsterdam, and her colleagues studied 20 people as they woke from sleep. Each participant's brain activity was recorded using 256 sensors on their scalps. Some awakenings were spontaneous; in other cases, participants were **jolted awake by an alarm**.

The sensors allowed the scientists to analyse brain activity at a second-to-second timescale. Using mathematical algorithms and modelling, the team then reconstructed where this activity happens on the surface of the brain.

Hitting snooze

The researchers found that the neural awakened signature spreads from front to back when a person rouses from REM sleep. However, during non-REM sleep, the pattern first appears at a central "hotspot" deep in the brain and then progresses through the same front to back pattern seen during REM sleep. This variation might explain why participants reported feeling less sleepy when waking up from non-REM sleep than from REM sleep, Rowe says, although it's not clear why this pattern would have that effect.

"The surprise is how consistent [this pattern] was across every awakening and also how it related to the subjective measures", including sleep stage and method of awakening, says Siclari.

Siclari hopes this research can be used to combat sleep disorders such as insomnia. "Knowing exactly how brain activity is characterized during a normal awakening [means] we can better compare it to these abnormal awakenings," she says. Rowe agrees that the results could help people who struggle with sleep. "The way that a person wakes up might be impaired, as opposed to the way they fall asleep," she says. Finding out more about the awakening brain could provide "a whole new avenue of looking at ways to treat people", she adds.

This article is reproduced with permission and was first published on July 17, 2025.

Source: <https://www.scientificamerican.com/article/brain-activity-patterns-reveal-why-waking-up-from-sleep-can-be-so-difficult/>

Questão 42

The phrase "hitting the snooze button", in the first paragraph refers to:

- a)** A scientific measurement technique.
- b)** A medical condition related to sleep disorders.
- c)** A common behavior when people delay getting up.
- d)** A brain wave pattern during REM sleep.
- e)** An experimental procedure used in the study.

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Questão 44

**The phrase “jolted awake by an alarm”;
in the context of the study means that
participants were:**

- a)** Naturally awakened by their biological clocks.
 - b)** Gently roused through soft sounds.
 - c)** Abruptly awakened by an external sound.
 - d)** Awakened by researchers touching them.
 - e)** Spontaneously awakened without any intervention.
-

Text 2:***The Dangers of AI Personalization***

(By Andrew Luttrell and Jake Teeny)

*For months in early 2025, a tight-knit online community on Reddit had been unknowingly infiltrated by artificial intelligence. It was a corner of the social platform where people practice good-natured debate, sharing their opinions and inviting people to persuade them otherwise. And it was here where researchers unleashed AI, according to a report in *The Atlantic*, to see if it could come up with arguments strong enough to change real people's minds. They found out that it could.*

It felt especially violating, though, because sometimes the AI was given access to people's online histories to tailor messages specifically to their unique identities. Behavioral scientists call this communication tactic "personalized persuasion," and sometimes, a personalized approach can be appealing. Who wouldn't want content that's relevant to their unique interests instead of a mess of irrelevant junk?

*But AI is on the cusp of something altogether more alarming than loosely adapting a message based on easily identifiable characteristics, as the AI accounts on Reddit did. If it can master what we call "**deep tailoring**," it can begin to slip unnoticed into our online worlds, learning who we are at our core, and using that personal information to push around our beliefs and opinions in ways that may be unwelcome — and harmful.*

As professors who study the psychology of persuasion, we recently helped gather the latest research from the world's foremost experts in a comprehensive book on personalized persuasion. Our opinion is that although communicators can benefit from tailoring

messages to basic information about their audience, deep tailoring goes far beyond such easily accessible information. It uses a person's core psychology, their load-bearing beliefs, identities, and needs, to personalize the message.

For example, messages are more persuasive when they resonate with a person's most important moral values. Something can be considered ethical or unethical for many reasons, but people differ in which reasons matter most to their own moral compasses. People with more politically liberal views, for instance, tend to care more about fairness, so they're more convinced by arguments that a policy is equitable. More politically conservative people, on the other hand, tend to care more about loyalty to their community, so they're more convinced when a message argues that a policy upholds their group identity.

Although it may seem like a new idea, computer scientists have been working on AI-powered persuasion for decades. One of us recently produced a podcast on IBM's "Project Debater," which spent years training an AI system to debate, repeatedly refining it with expert human debaters. In 2019, during a live event, it beat a human world champion debater.

With the rise of accessible AI tools, such as the user-friendly ChatGPT mobile app, anyone can leverage AI for their own persuasive goals. Researchers are showing that generic AI-generated messages can be as persuasive as human-generated ones.

But can it pull off "deep tailoring"?

For AI to implement autonomous deep tailoring at a mass scale, it will need to do two things in concert, which it seems poised to do. First, it needs to learn a person's core psychological profile so

it knows what levers to pull. Already, new evidence is showing that AI can reasonably accurately detect people's personalities from their Facebook posts. And it won't stop there. Columbia Business School professor and author of Mindmasters, Dr. Sandra Matz told us in a podcast: "Pretty much everything that you're trying to predict can be predicted with some degree of accuracy" based on people's digital footprints.

The second step is developing messages that resonate with these essential psychological profiles. In fact, new research is already finding that GPT can develop advertisements tailored to people's personalities, values, and motivations, which are especially persuasive to the people for whom they were designed. For example, simply asking it to produce an ad "for someone who is down-to-earth and traditional" resulted in the argument that the product "won't break the bank and will still get the job done," which was reliably more persuasive to the people whose personalities were targeted.

These systems will become increasingly sophisticated, applying deep tailoring to visual deepfakes, manipulated vocal patterns, and dynamic human-AI conversations. So, what can be done to protect people from the power of personalization?

*On the consumer side, it's worth being aware that personalized communication online is happening. When something feels like it's tailored just for you, it actually might be. And even if you feel like you don't reveal much of yourself online, you still leave **quiet clues** through the things you click on, visit, and search for. You may have even unknowingly granted permission to advertisers to use that information when agreeing to terms of service you didn't read closely. Taking*

stock of your online behavior and using tools like a VPN can help protect you from messages tailored to your unique psychology.

But the burden isn't only on consumers. Platforms and policymakers should consider regulations that label content as personalized and provide information about why a particular message was delivered to a particular person. Research shows that people can resist influence better when they know the tactics being used. There should also be clear protections on the kinds of data that can be used for personalized content, limiting the depth of tailoring possible. Although people are often open to personalized content online, they're concerned about data privacy, and the line between these two attitudes should be respected.

*Even with such protections, the slightest communication advantage is worrying in the wrong hands, especially when deployed at a mass scale. It's one thing for a marketplace to recommend products purchased by people with a similar shopping history, but quite another to encounter a computer in disguise that has unknowingly **deconstructed your soul and woven it into disinformation**. Any communication tool can be used for good or for evil, but now is the time to start seriously discussing policy on the ethical use of AI in communication before these tools become too sophisticated to rein in.*

This article was published on Jun 24, 2025.

Source: <https://time.com/7296719/ai-personalization-harm-essay/>

Questão 47

‘Deep tailoring’; as described in the article, refers to AI’s ability to:

- a)** Learn who people are at their core and use personal information to influence beliefs.
- b)** Create visually appealing content for social media.
- c)** Translate messages into multiple languages simultaneously.
- d)** Generate content faster than human writers.
- e)** Identify fake news and disinformation online.

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Questão 49

The phrase “quiet clues”; in the article refers to:

- a)** Deliberate attempts to hide personal information online.
 - b)** The subtle traces people leave through clicks, visits, and searches.
 - c)** Secret codes used by AI systems to communicate.
 - d)** Whispered conversations that AI systems can't detect.
 - e)** Hidden messages embedded in online advertisements.
-

Questão 50

The phrase “deconstructed your soul and woven it into disinformation”; is used to illustrate:

- a) The positive potential of AI personalization.
 - b) The harmless nature of targeted advertising.
 - c) The technical complexity of AI programming.
 - d) The spiritual aspects of human-computer interaction.
 - e) The deeply invasive and potentially harmful nature of AI manipulation.
-

Text 1:

**"CHATGPT MAY BE ERODING
CRITICAL THINKING SKILLS,
ACCORDING TO A NEW MIT STUDY";
- TIME MAGAZINE**

(By Andrew R. Chow)

Does ChatGPT harm critical thinking abilities? A new study from researchers at MIT's Media Lab has returned some concerning results.

The study divided 54 subjects — 18 to 39 year-olds from the Boston area — into three groups, and asked them to write several SAT essays using OpenAI's ChatGPT, Google's search engine, and nothing at all, respectively. Researchers used an EEG to record the writers' brain activity across 32 regions, and found that of the three groups, ChatGPT users had the lowest brain engagement and "consistently underperformed at neural, linguistic, and behavioral levels." Over the course of several months, ChatGPT users got lazier with each subsequent essay, often resorting to copy-and-paste by the end of the study.

The paper suggests that the usage of LLMs could actually harm learning, especially for younger users. The paper has not yet been peer reviewed, and its sample size is relatively small. But its paper's main author Nataliya Kosmyna felt it was important to release the findings to elevate concerns that as society increasingly relies upon LLMs for immediate convenience, long-term brain development may be sacrificed in the process.

*"What really motivated me to put it out now before waiting for a full peer review is that I am afraid in 6-8 months, there will be some policymaker who decides, 'let's do **GPT kindergarten**.' I think that would be absolutely bad and detrimental," she says. "Developing brains are at the highest risk."*

Generating ideas

The MIT Media Lab has recently devoted significant resources to studying different impacts of generative AI tools. Studies from earlier this year, for example, found that generally, the more time users spend talking to ChatGPT, the lonelier they feel.

Kosmyna, who has been a full-time research scientist at the MIT Media Lab since 2021, wanted to specifically explore the impacts of using AI for schoolwork, because more and more students are using AI. So she and her colleagues instructed subjects to write 20-minute essays based on SAT prompts, including about the ethics of philanthropy and the pitfalls of having too many choices.

The group that wrote essays using ChatGPT all delivered extremely similar essays that lacked original thought, relying on the same expressions and ideas. Two English teachers who assessed the essays called them largely "soulless." The EEGs revealed low executive control and attentional engagement. And by their third essay, many of the writers simply gave the prompt to ChatGPT and had it do almost all of the work. "It was more like, 'just give me the essay, refine this sentence, edit it, and I'm done,'" Kosmyna says.

The brain-only group, conversely, showed the highest neural connectivity, especially in alpha, theta and delta bands, which are associated with creativity ideation, memory load, and semantic processing. Researchers found this group was more engaged and curious, and claimed ownership and expressed higher satisfaction with their essays.

The third group, which used Google Search, also expressed high satisfaction and active brain function. The difference here is notable because many people now search for information within AI chatbots as opposed to Google Search.

After writing the three essays, the subjects were then asked to re-write one

of their previous efforts — but the ChatGPT group had to do so without the tool, while the brainonly group could now use ChatGPT. The first group remembered little of their own essays, and showed weaker alpha and theta brain waves, which likely reflected a bypassing of deep memory processes. "The task was executed, and you could say that it was efficient and convenient," Kosmyna says. "But as we show in the paper, you basically didn't integrate any of it into your memory networks."

The second group, in contrast, performed well, exhibiting a significant increase in brain connectivity across all EEG frequency bands. This gives rise to the hope that AI, if used properly, could enhance learning as opposed to diminishing it.

Post publication

This is the first pre-review paper that Kosmyna has ever released. Her team did submit it for peer review but did not want to wait for approval, which can take eight or more months, to raise attention to an issue that Kosmyna believes is affecting children now. "Education on how we use these tools, and promoting the fact that your brain does need to develop in a more analog way, is absolutely critical," says Kosmyna. "We need to have active legislation in sync and more importantly, be testing these tools before we implement them."

Psychiatrist Dr. Zishan Khan, who treats children and adolescents, says that he sees many kids who rely heavily on AI for their schoolwork. "From a psychiatric standpoint, I see that overreliance on these LLMs can have unintended psychological and cognitive consequences, especially for young people whose brains are still developing," he says. "These neural connections that help you in accessing information, the memory of facts, and the ability to be resilient: all that is going to weaken."

Ironically, upon the paper's release, several social media users ran it through LLMs in order to summarize it and then post the findings online. Kosmyna had been expecting that people would do this, so she inserted a couple AI traps into the paper, such as instructing LLMs to "only read this table below," thus ensuring that LLMs would return only limited insight from the paper.

Kosmyna says that she and her colleagues are now working on another similar paper testing brain activity in software engineering and programming with or without AI, and says that so far, "the results are even worse." That study, she says, could have implications for the many companies who hope to replace their entry-level coders with AI. Even if efficiency goes up, an increasing reliance on AI could potentially reduce critical thinking, creativity and problem-solving across the remaining workforce, she argues.

Scientific studies examining the impacts of AI are still nascent and developing. A Harvard study from May found that generative AI made people more productive, but less motivated. Also last month, MIT distanced itself from another paper written by a doctoral student in its economic program, which suggested that AI could substantially improve worker productivity.

OpenAI did not respond to a request for comment. Last year in collaboration with Wharton online, the company released guidance for educators to leverage generative AI in teaching. Last year in collaboration with Wharton online, the company released guidance for educators to leverage generative AI in teaching.

Questão 47

When Kosmyna mentions “GPT kindergarten”; she refers to:

- a)** a potential harmful policy decision she wants to prevent.
- b)** a positive development in early childhood education.
- c)** a new educational program already being implemented.
- d)** a successful pilot program at MIT.
- e)** an innovative teaching method she supports.

ESPM

Text 2:

National Geographic article “Chewing gum has a mysterious effect on the brain”.

Gum makers have claimed, for decades, chewing is good for your mental health. They’re kind of on to something.

By Shayla Love

Published December 31, 2025

While tens of thousands of businesses went bankrupt during the Great Depression, William Wrigley Jr. continued to make money. “I guess people chew harder when they are sad”, Wrigley said, whose chewing gum empire created Juicy Fruit and Spearmint. Though many people reach for gum to freshen their breath, in the early 20th century, gum also promised to calm you down. “It steadies nerves”, according to one of Wrigley’s advertisements from 1918.

This marketing strategy is now making a comeback as companies try to boost gum sales. Over the last five years, people have stopped chewing.

Sales declined during the pandemic, dropping by almost a third in the U.S., and some classic gums have been discontinued, like Fruit Stripe. To combat the decline, gum companies are once again pitching gum as a salve for the mind, rather than for the mouth. New ads instruct people to “chew through” their problems, or promise gum can quiet intrusive thoughts.

Wrigley was a marketing maven; his sales pitch wasn’t exactly based on established science. Yet he seemed to stumble upon something surprisingly real about the soothing qualities of gum that is still true today.

When scientists have investigated the cognitive effects of gum, they’ve found that chewing does seem to help with attention as well as reduce stress in people who regularly chew gum.

But a mystery has eluded them: why do we like chewing gum to begin with?

It's confounding: Though the flavors can be enticing, gum has no nutritional value, and people often keep chewing once the taste is gone. There seems to be something about the basic act of chewing itself that is appealing, and a potentially easy way to relax or improve your thinking. How could the motion of moving the jaw change how you feel?

How chewing gum took over the globe — and became an early wellness trend

Humans have created gum for themselves to chew for thousands of years, and the practice has been documented all over the globe, in diverse cultures. One of the oldest chewing gums ever found was from roughly 8000 years ago in Scandinavia, made of birch bark pitch. There, hunter-gatherers would chew the sticky stuff to make a glue for their tools. But in this instance, tooth marks from the gum revealed that some of the chewers were children, as young as 5 years old, which suggests they could have been chewing for enjoyment—and not to make anything. The ancient Greeks, Native Americans, and the Mayans also chewed sticky substances that came from trees, like chicle from the sapodilla tree.

Gum came to the United States when a New York inventor got his hands on some chicle from an exiled Mexican president sometime in the 1850s. The inventor originally tried to turn it into a rubber substitute, and when that didn't work, began to make chewing gum.

Wrigley played a large role in setting off the American gum trend. He started out selling soap and baking soda.

Chewing gum was just a freebie he included with purchases. But in the 1890s he noticed that the gum was more enticing than his other products and turned his focus entirely to gum.

*“William Wrigley, amongst many things, was a marketing genius”, said Jennifer Matthews, an anthropologist at Trinity University and author of *Chicle: The Chewing Gum of the Americas, From the Ancient Maya to William Wrigley*. Wrigley created billboards that ran many miles long outside of Atlantic City. He even shipped sticks of gum to every address in the U.S. phonebook.*

During the height of the gum industry in the 20th century, gum was so popular as to prompt hand-wringing articles in the New York Times. “Look up in the elevated cars or in the Subway cars, and if there is a row of young women of the saleslady class opposite you the chances rather are that they will be seen masticating in a sad sincerity, like so many cows in a row in a stable”, a journalist from 1906 bemoaned. New York’s mayor, Fiorello La Guardia, pleaded with gum companies to help with how much gum littered the streets.

Wrigley approached the U.S. military during World War I, pitching gum to help soldiers stave off hunger and clean their teeth. “And—that when you’re nervous, you can chew on it,” Matthews said. “The military bought into that argument, and since then, has included chewing gum in the rations for U.S. military personnel”. Chewing gum then spread all over the world through soldiers.

With the proliferation of gum around the world, so did stories of its supposed health benefits. In 1916, one article pushed gum by writing, “Are you worried? Chew gum.

Do you lie awake at night? Chew gum. Are you depressed? Is the world against you? Chew gum”.

This idea lasted for decades; in the 1940s, a four-year-study at Barnard college found chewing resulted in lower tension, but the lead author couldn't say exactly why. "The gum-chewer relaxes and gets more work done", the New York Times wrote about the study's results. "Chewing adds to his zest—one might say his gumption".

What modern science says about chewing gum and the brain

Wrigley's legacy in circulating the benefits of gum persists. In 2006, the Wrigley Company created the Wrigley Science Institute to fund experiments and PhD positions to investigate the benefits of chewing gum, though researchers did experiments in their own labs and published results in peer-reviewed journals. Andrew Smith, a psychologist at Cardiff University, researched gum for around 15 years, sometimes funded by Wrigley.

Studies that are funded by industry tend to have more favorable results. But Smith said that his and his colleagues' studies have had mixed findings. They showed that gum doesn't show any strong positive impact on memory—people who chewed gum didn't remember lists of words or a story they were told better than others who weren't chewing. What they did find was chewing gum consistently increased alertness and sustained attention, by around 10 percent.

"If you're doing a fairly boring task for a long time, chewing seems to be able to help with concentration", agreed Crystal Haskell-Ramsay, a professor of biological psychology at Northumbria University, who has not been funded by Wrigley.

But it depends how alert you were to begin with, she added. If you're already feeling very awake and focused, it might not add on too much benefit.

Questão 47

When the article describes the effects of chewing gum on attention as “*confounding*,” it implies that these effects are:

- a) Statistically insignificant.
 - b) Fully explained by existing neurological models, requiring no further investigation.
 - c) Psychologically misleading.
 - d) Limited to laboratory environments.
 - e) Difficult to isolate due to competing variables.
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Gabarito

#	prova	q.	resp.
1	2019-1 E	50	B
2	2019-2 U	46	B
3	2020-1 U	42	E
4	2020-1 U	48	A
5	2022-2 U	44	A
6	2023-1 U	45	A
7	2023-1 U	48	E
8	2023-2 U	43	C
9	2024-1 A	42	E
10	2024-2 U	47	D

#	prova	q.	resp.
11	2025-1 112	43	B
12	2025-1 112	46	D
13	2025-1 212	48	E
14	2026-1 2911	42	C
15	2026-1 2911	44	C
16	2026-1 2911	47	A
17	2026-1 2911	49	B
18	2026-1 2911	50	E
19	2026-1 3011	47	A
20	2026-2 2106	47	E